The `Endpoint` middleware is responsible for executing the selected endpoint. If no matching endpoint is found, the last middleware, which is registered in the pipeline by the framework, returns a 404 Not Found HTTP status code.

Middleware that does not rely on routing, such as the static file middleware, should be placed prior to the call to `UseRouting`. Any middleware that needs to know about the selected endpoint is placed between `UseRouting` and `UseEndpoints`. Authorization middleware needs to know about the selected endpoint, for example, to determine whether the current user is authorized to access it.

4.1.1 Route templates

The `EndpointRouting` middleware attempts to match URLs to endpoints by comparing the *path* of the URL (the part after the domain) to route templates. A *route template* is a string representation of a route pattern. The call creates route templates to `MapRazorPages` in the `Endpoint` middleware registration, which instructs the framework to create endpoints based on Razor Pages conventions. Specifically, a collection of `RouteEndpoint` objects is created. A `RouteEndpoint` is a type of endpoint that can be used in URL matching and generation.

Route templates for Razor pages are created from the file path and name of Razor files found in the default root directory: the Pages folder.

Note